

BOUNTY HUNTERS' GUILD

LAST HIT

Official Prototype Rulebook

2-6 hunters • 25-60 minutes • Field-Test Edition v1.5

OPEN CONTRACT

Everyone fights. Only one gets paid.

Work together just long enough to bring the monsters down—then land the final blow and claim the Reputation for yourself.

Secretly select a bounty. Commit scarce Attention. Shape the attack order. Build Momentum. Bargain, bluff, and split your rivals' attention at exactly the right moment.

Race to 15 Reputation and earn the title of Master Hunter.

1. The Contract

In Last Hit, hunters pursue shared bounties. Damage remains on each monster, but only the hunter whose attack defeats it claims the card and its Reputation. Every hit brings the table closer to a payday—and may hand that payday to somebody else.

Goal. Finish the game with the most Reputation after one or more hunters reach 15.

Game at a Glance

Element	Rule
Players	2–6
Active bounties	2 with 2–3 hunters; 3 with 4–6 hunters
Planning	Simultaneous target and Attention selection
Attack damage	1–3 damage from a d6, modified by Momentum and Boons
Victory	Reach 15 Reputation; finish all lineups programmed that round

2. Components

- 20 Bounty cards using the frequency spread in Section 14
- 1 six-sided attack die; additional dice for Exposed Boons
- 30 identical-backed Boon tokens forming a facedown Boon Supply
- 6 Attention cubes, 3 Momentum tokens, and 1 hunter token per hunter
- Target cards A, B, C, and PRE for each hunter
- Attention cards 1–6 and PARE for each hunter
- Damage markers, Reputation markers and a 0–20 Reputation track
- 1 First Hunter marker and a central board with bounty slots and lineup spaces

Information

Available and Spent Attention, Momentum totals, bounty Health, accumulated damage, Reputation, and the number of staged Boons are public. Planned cards, Boon faces, and advanced-variant banked Boons remain hidden.

3. Setup

1. Create two bounty slots (A-B) for two or three hunters, or three slots (A-C) for four to six hunters.
2. Shuffle the Bounty deck. Reveal one bounty into each active slot.
3. Shuffle all 30 Boons facedown to form the Boon Supply. Keep a Used Boons area beside it.
4. Give each hunter six Available Attention, no Momentum, their hunter token, and both programming-card sets.
5. Place every Reputation marker on 0. Randomly assign the First Hunter marker.

4. Round Sequence

Phase	What happens
1. Recover	Recover up to 2 Attention.
2. Program	Secretly pair one Target card with one Attention card.
3. Reveal	Reveal together and spend committed Attention.
4. Position	Low Attention places first; high Attention places last.
5. Hunt	Resolve each lineup from front to back.
6. Victory	After all programmed lineups resolve, check for 15 Reputation.
7. Prepare	Hunters who prepared recover up to 2 more Attention.
8. Neglect	Each untargeted bounty gains a facedown Boon, to a maximum of 3.
9. Refill	Replace claimed bounties and pass First Hunter clockwise.

5. Recover and Program

Recover

Move up to two Attention cubes from Spent to Available. A hunter can never hold more than six Available Attention.

Program

Each hunter secretly places one Target card and one Attention card facedown together.

Plan	Card pair	Result
Hunt	A, B, or C + 1-6	Target that bounty and commit the chosen Attention.
Prepare	PRE + PARE	Target no bounty and commit no Attention.

The PRE and PARE cards disguise a Prepare choice among normal card selections. A hunter may not choose a number exceeding their Available Attention. A hunter with none must Prepare.

Prepare cooldown. After choosing Prepare, leave PRE faceup beside your mat. You cannot Prepare during the following round and must Hunt instead. Return PRE to your hand after revealing that Hunt. A canceled attack still clears the cooldown because you programmed a Hunt.

6. Reveal and Position

Reveal

Reveal all card pairs simultaneously. Every hunting player immediately moves their committed Attention from Available to Spent. It remains spent even if the bounty is claimed before that hunter attacks.

Build Attack Lineups

For each bounty, hunters place their tokens in ascending order of committed Attention: lowest first, highest last. When placing, insert your token at the front, back, or anywhere between tokens already present. Never change the relative order of tokens already placed.

Ties. First Hunter has the highest priority, followed clockwise. Among tied hunters, resolve placement from lowest priority to highest so the highest-priority hunter makes the final insertion.

Four-hunter cap (five- and six-player games). If more than four hunters target one bounty, only the four highest Attention commitments enter its lineup. At a tied cutoff, First Hunter priority determines who qualifies. Every excluded hunter loses that Hunt, keeps all committed Attention Spent, and cannot retarget, Prepare, attack, reveal or consume a Boon, commit Momentum, gain Momentum, or use Split Attention for that bounty this round. Keep excluded hunter tokens off the board. The four admitted hunters then build the lineup normally.

WHY ATTENTION MATTERS

Attention does not increase damage. It buys information and control over attack position. A larger commitment may aim for a final hit, move forward to consume a Boon, or react to everyone who committed less.

7. Resolve Hunts

Resolve bounty slots in letter order, A through C. Resolve each completed lineup from front to back. If a bounty is claimed, cancel all remaining attacks in its lineup; their committed Attention remains spent.

Attack Sequence

- 1. Reveal one staged Boon.** If the bounty has any, randomly take one from beneath it and reveal it.
- 2. Commit Momentum.** Declare and spend any amount held. Each adds +1 damage; all committed Momentum is lost.
- 3. Roll.** Roll the attack die and any additional die granted by Exposed. Resolve an optional reroll now.
- 4. Announce provisional damage.** Convert dice, then add Momentum and Boon modifiers.
- 5. Split Attention.** Eligible rival hunters may reduce the provisional damage.
- 6. Apply final damage.** Place damage on the bounty after reduction, to a minimum of 0.
- 7. Resolve the result.** Claim a defeated bounty; otherwise gain 1 Momentum if the attack dealt at least 1 final damage.
- 8. Refresh if triggered.** After the attack ends, resolve any revealed Refresh symbol.

Attack Die

d6	Base damage
1	0
2	1
3-4	2
5-6	3

Natural 1 - Miss. A natural 1 deals 0 base damage, but committed Momentum and Boon effects still apply normally. If provisional damage remains 0, skip Split Attention.

8. Momentum

After a nonlethal attack deals at least 1 final damage, gain 1 Momentum, to a maximum of 3. An attack that claims a bounty or is reduced to 0 damage grants none.

After revealing the staged Boon but before rolling, commit as much Momentum as you wish. Each committed token adds +1 damage. Return every committed token to the supply regardless of the roll, Split Attention, or result.

9. Split Attention

After provisional damage is announced, open a brief discussion window of approximately 10–15 seconds.

Core Rule: Open Contributions

- Every other admitted hunter in that bounty's current Attack Lineup is eligible. The attacker and any hunter excluded by the four-hunter cap are not.
- Eligible hunters may openly move any number of Available Attention cubes to Spent.
- Each cube reduces the attack by 1 damage, to a minimum of 0.
- Contributed cubes cannot be withdrawn. Promises are nonbinding until cubes are physically spent.
- End the window when all eligible hunters pass or the timer expires.

Hunters assigned to other bounties may talk, bargain, or mislead, but cannot contribute Attention.

Large-group timing. With five or six hunters, use a strict 10-second Split Attention window after provisional damage is announced.

Advanced Variant: Blind Contributions

After discussion, each eligible hunter secretly selects one Attention card. A numbered card pledges that many cubes; PARE means 0/pass. Reveal simultaneously, pay every pledge, and reduce damage by the total. A hunter cannot select more than their Available Attention. All pledged cubes are spent, including excess reduction.

10. Claiming Bounties

If total damage equals or exceeds Health, the attacker lands the last hit:

- Take the Bounty card face up and gain its printed Reputation.
- Move every staged but unconsumed Boon from that bounty to Used Boons.
- Remove its damage and cancel all remaining attacks in its lineup.
- Leave the slot empty until Refill.

Damage never carries to another bounty. Damage on surviving bounties persists between rounds.

11. Boons and Neglect

An ignored monster grows less alert. At the end of each round, every surviving bounty that no hunter targeted draws the top facedown Boon from the Boon Supply. Stage it beneath that bounty without revealing it. A bounty may hold no more than three.

At the beginning of each attack, reveal and consume at most one staged Boon. Apply it only to that attack.

Qty.	Boon	Effect
10	Second Chance	After rolling, you may reroll the normal attack die once. Keep the new result.
10	Off Guard	+1 damage to this attack.
5	Exposed	Roll one additional attack die and add its converted damage.
5	Refresh	No attack bonus. After this attack, refresh the Boon Supply.

Used Boons

Place consumed Boons faceup in Used Boons. If the supply is empty when a Boon is needed, shuffle Used Boons facedown to create a new supply. Boons still staged beneath surviving bounties are unaffected.

Refresh Supply

After an attack that revealed a Refresh Boon fully resolves, combine the triggering token, every token in Used Boons, and the remaining Boon Supply. Shuffle them facedown to form a new supply. Staged Boons remain beneath their monsters. If that attack claimed the bounty, first move its unconsumed staged Boons to Used Boons, then refresh.

12. Prepare, Refill, and Victory

Prepare

After all hunts and the victory check, each hunter who played PRE + PARE recovers up to two additional Attention. Combined with normal Recover, Prepare can restore up to four Attention during the round. Leave PRE faceup to show that Prepare is unavailable next round; the hunter must program a Hunt before recovering PRE.

Neglect and Refill

Add Boons to untargeted surviving bounties, then fill empty slots from the Bounty deck. If the deck runs out, record each hunter's claimed-bounty count, then shuffle all claimed Bounty cards to form a new deck; Reputation already scored is never lost. Pass First Hunter clockwise.

End of the Game

When any hunter reaches or exceeds 15 Reputation, finish every Attack Lineup programmed that round. Do not begin another round. The highest Reputation wins. If tied, the tied hunter with more claimed Bounty cards wins; if still tied, share victory.

13. Advanced Variant: Hidden Opportunity

Use this optional variant only after everyone understands normal Momentum. It replaces the reward for a qualifying nonlethal hit.

After a nonlethal attack deals at least 1 final damage, choose one:

- Gain 1 visible Momentum; or
- Draw 1 Boon secretly and place it facedown in your Momentum pool.

Momentum and banked Boons share a capacity of 3. Before rolling, the attacker may commit any number of tokens from this pool. Visible Momentum gives +1 damage each; committed Boons are flipped and resolved. Every committed token is spent and cannot be withdrawn.

Staged Boons remain tied to their monsters and cannot be banked. Unrevealed banked Boons remain with their hunter when the Boon Supply refreshes. If the supply and Used Boons are both empty because every Boon is staged or banked, a hunter may choose only Momentum.

14. Starter Bounty Stack

The stack mixes standard, lean, and rare premium contracts. Same-Health Reputation variance creates a crowding tradeoff: premium bounties are more valuable but more likely to attract rival hunters.

Bounty	Health	Reputation	Qty.
Feral Imp	4	2	2
Razorwing Harpy	4	2	2
Ironhide Boar	5	3	2
Grave Hound	5	3	1
Gilded Manticore	5	4	1
Hill Ogre	6	3	2
Moss Troll	6	4	2
Stone Golem	7	4	3
Crystal Basilisk	7	5	1
Mire Hydra	8	5	2
Ember Drake	9	6	2

15. Complete Example

The Moss Troll has 6 Health and one staged Boon. Ari commits 1 Attention, Cy commits 2, and Bo commits 3. Ari places first. Cy inserts behind Ari. Bo, placing with full information, inserts at the front. The final lineup is Bo → Ari → Cy.

Bo reveals Off Guard, commits 1 Momentum, and rolls 1 damage: provisional damage is 3. Ari and Cy are both eligible for Split Attention. After discussion, Ari spends 1 Attention and Cy spends none, reducing the attack to 2. The Troll survives, so Bo gains 1 Momentum. Play proceeds to Ari, then Cy. Whoever deals the damage that reaches 6 claims the Troll's 4 Reputation.

16. Rules Clarifications

Question	Ruling
Can I hunt with 0 Attention?	No. A hunt requires 1–6. Use PRE + PARE to Prepare.
Can I Prepare twice in a row?	No. After Prepare, you must program a Hunt before PRE returns to your hand.
Can I divide my plan?	No. Choose exactly one bounty or Prepare.
What if 5+ hunters target one bounty?	Only the four highest Attention commitments qualify; excluded hunters lose the Hunt and their committed Attention.
Does high Attention add damage?	No. It grants later lineup placement.
Can I spend all my Momentum?	Yes. Declare any amount held before rolling.
Who may use Split Attention?	Other hunters in the same current lineup only.
Does 0 final damage gain Momentum?	No.
Does a natural 1 cancel modifiers?	No. It is 0 base damage; Momentum and Boons still apply.
Does one attack reveal every staged Boon?	No. At most one.
Are negotiations binding?	No. Only cubes spent or cards revealed are binding.
What happens to a canceled attack?	It does not occur and gains no Momentum; committed Attention stays spent.
Can resources exceed their limits?	No: 6 Available Attention and 3 Momentum/pool slots.

Round Reference

Step	Reminder
Recover	Recover up to 2 Attention.
Program	A/B/C + 1–6, or PRE + PARE.
Reveal	Spend committed Attention.
Position	In 5–6 player games, admit the top four commitments; then low inserts first and high last.
Attack	Boon → Momentum → roll → provisional damage → Split Attention → final damage.
Reward	Claim on the last hit; otherwise gain Momentum after 1+ final damage.
Close	Victory → Prepare → Neglect → Refill → pass First Hunter.

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